The Call

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/58979272.

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General Audiences

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She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)

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Adora (She-Ra), Light Hope (She-Ra), Glimmer (She-Ra), Angella (She-Ra), Juliet (She-Ra)

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by AuthorWithoutaName

Summary

Adora is the second daughter of the Queen of Bright Moon. She is Glimmer's sister and one day they both hope to join the Rebellion and bring an end to the Horde. Unfortunately, according to Angella that day will have to wait until they're older. Lately though, Adora has been having some strange dreams. Dreams involving a strange sword.

Notes

Basically this is an AU where Adora was raised in Bright Moon alongside Glimmer rather than the Horde. I thought about making a whole fic about this scenario but for now I think I am just going to post this as a one-shot, see how it goes and maybe write it all out later. I have a couple of more She-Ra fics that I would like to finish and post soon.

The day had been long. Or rather, the last few weeks had been unbearably long. Each day had stretched on, seemingly without end. Relief should come at night but lately even sleep had been unrestful. Plagued by strange dreams, Adora found herself trying to stay up most nights now, using the extra time to either study or even exercise in the privacy of her room. She hoped that no one had noticed. In class, she would find herself nodding off, the lecture of her teacher lulling her already tired mind to sleep. More than once, she was startled awake after her head had slammed against her desk. Glimmer would glance at her looking concerned and more than once had gone up to her after they were done with their lessons to ask if she was okay. So far, Adora was able to brush it off and just say that everything was fine and it was simply that the lesson was boring. Glimmer wouldn't argue with her but she didn't look convinced either. At least she pretended to accept her answer.

Angella had noticed as well. She had cornered Adora a few times in the last few weeks to ask how she was and if she was sleeping well. Adora would switch up her lies, either saying that she just got caught reading some interesting story and didn't realize how late it had gotten or just say that yes, she had slept well, despite the clear evidence that she hadn't. Angella would usually press more than Glimmer would but for the most part, she would just let her be, after all, she was busy. Adora appreciated the Queen and everything she had done for her, such as taking her in when was just a baby found abandoned in some field. She didn't cause more trouble for the Queen, who was trying to protect her kingdom during a war.

When they were young, her and Glimmer had made a promise to stop the war when they were older. Both of them longed to fight in the Rebellion and stop the Horde. They both watched as their mom, the Queen mourned the loss of King Micah and many friends over the years. Both of them had mourned for King Micah as well, after all, that was their dad but they also understood (somewhat) that sometimes war meant loss. they were about seven, maybe eight when they had made that promise.

It had been a particularly bad day for the Queen, who had been struggling to keep it together for her children. Both of them had witnessed her finally lose it after a scouting group had returned from their patrol and sadly announced that one of the towns on the outskirts of Bright Moon had been annihilated by the Horde. From what they had said, there were no survivors. From that day on, both girls resolved to learn all they could about war, everything from fighting to strategy. They had got bold enough to tell the Queen about their plan to fight in the Rebellion when they were finally of age about a few weeks later. Angella had outright forbade them from such talk and thinking but after awhile, relented, but only under the condition that they waited until she said they were old enough and in the meanwhile, they would learn and study about warfare, in addition to their royal studies.

Glimmer began to learn how to incorporate her teleporting in fights, whereas Adora began to study swordsmanship under the watchful eyes of General Juilet. Unlike Glimmer, she had no magical abilities and would therefore have to make up for it with old fashioned swordsmanship. She was good at it too, General Juilet had called her a prodigy when Angella had asked her how Adora's lessons were going. Adora had beamed at the praise and for a moment, she felt as though she had finally found her spot in Bright Moon. She could be a protector. She would learn everything she could about swordsmanship and become the hero that the Rebellion desperately needed. Glimmer would one day be queen, that was her birth-right, but Adora would be at her right hand, ready to protect her sister and the rest of the kingdom.

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Both girls would be sixteen soon. They were still too young to be in the Rebellion. Whenever they would ask Angella if they could join the fight, the Queen would just sigh and tell them to enjoy being young for now, their time in the Rebellion would come soon enough but they weren't ready yet. One night Glimmer had gotten mad enough at that answer that after dinner, she voiced her irritation to Adora when they were alone.

“What does she mean ‘we’re not ready’?!” she huffed, teleporting a couple of feet above her bed so she fell dramatically on it, “We’ve been studying for years! Years, Adora!”

“Maybe she’s right though,” Adora tired to reason, leaning against a wall, her arms crossed, “I mean-”

“Maybe she’s not ready,” Glimmer interrupted, paying Adora no mind. She continued to ramble on but Adora’s thoughts drifted elsewhere, drowning out Glimmer’s rant. Last night she had a strange dream. Everything in it had felt important at the time but after she had woken up, she had forgotten about… until now that is. She tried to remember the dream but nothing came to her. Well… Nothing except the image of a sword. It was weird though, most of the swords in Bright Moon all looked the same. Now, there were different styles of swords, sure but for the most part, no sword was completely unique in Bright Moon. This sword though… It looked… strange. Adora tried to rack her brain for where she might’ve seen like it before… “Adora!”

She startled out of her thoughts as Glimmer appeared before her. The irritation on Glimmer’s face still present as she glared at her, clearly still annoyed with the discussion at their latest family dinner.

“Sorry,” Adora mumbled, stepping away from the wall and rubbing the back of her head sheepishly, “anyway, you were saying?”

Glimmer huffed and then continued her tirade on how their mom was being unfair and why she should just trust them. Adora tried to listen but her mind kept wandering back to that dream and to the sword.

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Sneaking out was probably a stupid idea. Adora wasn’t known for causing trouble. She was usually seen as the good example and because of that, she was often tasked with ensuring that Glimmer

followed her example and didn't do anything dangerous or anything that would get both of them (or usually just Glimmer) in trouble. Sneaking out was something that no one would expect from her. She had a good reason for leaving the castle in the middle of the night though… Well, she thought it was a good reason at least. She had fallen asleep early, a full day of studying and practicing swordsmanship had worn her out (plus not sleeping much the previous night had helped to ensure that she would collapse as soon as she got up to her room after family dinner). Her sleep had been peaceful at first but then came the strange dreams…

The sword had popped up, it always did and she always remembered that part of the dream. This time, however, she could remember more about the dream when she awoke. So many images had flashed in her head, the Whispering Woods, a sizable castle made of blue crystals, a spaceship, a warrior in almost all white and glowing standing alone on a cliff, and lastly a towering woman who looked as though she was sapphire. The woman's eyes had met hers and it was as if she could read every thought and every memory that Adora had. Her mouth opened and her monotone voice came out, "Balance must be restored. Etheria must seek a hero. Adora, meet me at the Crystal Castle.".

She had tried to go back to sleep after startling awake. No matter how hard she tried though, sleep would not come. So now, she was alone and wandering through the Whispering Woods in the middle of the night. It was probably stupid. It was just a dream. She should've just waited until morning. She should've just talked to Glimmer about the weird dreams she had been having or maybe Angella or maybe even General Juliet, the woman was basically her mentor and had offered Adora advice on many different aspects of her life over the years. She considered the woman another aunt at this point… Still though… For some reason she did not want to tell the others about what she had been dreaming about at night. She was already different from everyone else at Bright Moon, and her weird dreams just felt as though they were another aspect of her that would separate her from her home, from her family.

The Whispering Woods were hard to navigate during the day and at night they could be outright dangerous. She had already traveled deep into them and still hadn't seen anything from her dream, no cliff, no castle, no sword… Maybe the dreams meant nothing. She stopped and turned to go back the way she came. She took one step back towards home when-

"...Adora…" It was the same monotone voice from her dream. She felt the voice pull at her, as if it were directing her to another direction. She turned again, this time to her right. She glanced back at the path that would lead her home. She wasn't sure what time it was now. She should go back and try to get some more sleep. She hesitated. She could go back home and maybe forget all of this. She felt the pull again though and stepped forward, away from the path that would take her home. She marched further through the woods. The voice hadn't come back. She was just able to debate with herself on whether she should give up when something flashed out of the corner of her eyes. She glanced in the direction of the flash and saw it… The sword.

It glowed. Roots wrapped around it, holding it in place it seemed. She froze, staring at it. The hilt was gold, which wasn't unheard of in Bright Moon, plenty of swords had golden hilts but none had the blue oval stone that this one had. It almost reminded her of a runestone, like the one that Glimmer and Angella used. She took a cautious step forward. She hesitated, stopping before taking a second step. The voice returned but this time it almost sounded like her own voice rather than the monotone of the blue lady, "...Etheria must seek a hero…". A hero… Maybe that could be her. She took another step towards the sword and another until she stood just in front of it. She reached out to grab the hilt and-

"...Adora… You must meet me at the Crystal Castle…".

She was on her back and staring up at the darkened night sky. Something glowed nearby, providing light. She turned her head to look at it… the sword… She pushed herself up in a sitting position and watched the sword wearily. Maybe she should go home. She could come back and bring others with her to get the sword. But

how would she explain how she knew where the sword was? She could probably convince Glimmer and Bow easily to explore the Whispering Woods and pretend that she just stumbled upon the sword while with them. There was something strange about this sword. She got to her feet and turned her back to it. Yeah, she would forget about the sword for tonight. She would return home and pretend like nothing had happened tonight. She would… She sighed and turned to face the sword again. There were about ten different ways she could approach this and yet… She returned to the sword and reached out once more. Her hand gripped the hilt and… nothing… No flash blinded her and she was still standing. She brought her other hand to the hilt and pulled. The roots released the sword immediately. She brought it closer to herself and inspected it. The glow slowly faded until it looked more like a normal weapon.

"The crystal castle," Adora whispered to herself, her eyes still drawn to the sword in her hand. She turned over, studying the blade and then finally brought her arm to her side and scanned the woods. She had never seen a castle in the woods before. Her, Glimmer, and Bow had explored the woods a few times over the years, much to Angella's worry. Adora tried to limit their excursions, to save Angella some stress, but that didn't always stop Glimmer, so more often than not, she would just accompany her. It was more responsible to do that than to let Glimmer go alone, or that's what she told herself. She had to protect her sister. She wasn't worried if Bow was with her but Glimmer had a habit of exploring the woods by herself if Bow wasn't around.

She really needed to go back before Angella and everyone woke up. She had the sword now, so she could come back to find the crystal castle. Maybe Bow had seen it before, he said that he grew up around the woods and journeyed through them regularly. Suddenly, she couldn't remember the way home though. There were rumors that the woods could shift and make it hard for people to travel through them. Every path looked the same. This was a stupid idea. She should've just stayed home, stayed in room and maybe, just maybe finally tell Angella or even General Juliet about her strange dreams. Maybe one of them would have helped

her. Maybe- The sword abruptly glowed again and then just as quickly, the glow faded. It glowed again and then again faded. The glow ebbed off and on, prompting Adora to lift it once more and study it. The tip of the sword pointed forward and the glow stayed longer but it still dimmed after a few seconds…

"...The sword knows…" That monotone voice came back.

Adora glanced around the woods. There was no one. She was alone. She looked at the sword once more and then at the woods ahead of her. She took a hesitant step forward and then another, the sword held out in front of her. The glow would last a little longer but it would still pale every few seconds. The light started to dim more and more until it was almost non-existent. She glanced to her right and shifted the sword to point that direction and the glow returned stronger than before before fading away for just a moment, only to return again and so she wandered through the woods like that. Her sword seemingly guiding her to wherever this crystal castle was, or at least she hoped that's what was happening.

Slowly the darkness of the night began to fade away and the morning light appeared overhead. She didn't know how far she was at this point or even how she would return home. Everyone would be waking up soon. She really should've told someone, maybe Glimmer, where she was going. Glimmer could've covered for her. Hopefully Angella wouldn't be too mad if she discovered that she snuck out…

The sword lit up once more but the glow didn't fade. The glow grew stronger in fact, until it was almost blinding to look at it. Adora brought it down to her side and continued forward. The trees gradually dwindled until she came across a large clearing and in the middle of the clearing was a castle. "The crystal castle," Adora breathed. It was tall, not as tall as Bright Moon's castle but it was still impressive nevertheless. It was made up entirely of crystals. She slowly walked towards it, the sword still a blinding light by her side. The whole castle looked sealed shut. There was one spot that looked like it could be a door, it was shaped like a

triangle and had writing on it… First Ones' writing, she realized the more she studied it.

That was another thing that had marked her as different from everyone else, unlike Glimmer and Bow, actually unlike most of the citizens in Bright Moon actually, Adora could read First Ones' writings. Many took years to study the language. Adora had been able to read it almost immediately. She had seen the word pop up a few times in the books she had found about in the First Ones' writing 'Eternia'. Is Eternia a password? She cleared her throat and then uttered it aloud. Immediately the door opened, almost like it was beckoning her to go inside. She took one last glance behind her and then went inside. She took a few steps further in and the door shut suddenly behind her. She spun around and rushed back to it, "Wait!". She tried to pry it open but it wouldn't budge. "Eternia!" she cried in panic as she continued to try to pull the door apart. It opened once more, almost causing her to drop the sword. Her horror faded as she realized that all she needed to do to leave was just utter that word 'Eternia' once more. She stepped away from the door once more and it closed again. General Juliet would have scolded her for panicking so easily.

"A warrior must remain calm always, Adora," General Juliet reprimanded. She had tried to spar the General so they could get a sense of her skill level. She thought she was ready to spar, to prove that she was ready to fight but as soon as the General came out swinging her practice sword, Adora's mind had gone blank. She tried to fight but she barely lasted five minutes before the General easily knocked the wooden practice sword out of her hand. When the General asked why Adora had done so poorly, the excuse of "I got nervous," wasn't good enough. The General wasn't overly harsh, Adora was still a child then but she had to ensure that she knew how dangerous it was to allow fear to flood her mind.

Now that she knew that that word would allow her access in and out of the castle, she could relax… at least a little. She turned. Her back was now to the door and she continued further into the castle. It was spacious but not like the castle in Bright Moon. The

castle in Bright Moon, her home, had paintings decorating the walls, furniture everywhere, planets, it even had guards stationed among most hallways. This castle felt empty. Pillars rose up, stretching miles it seemed into the air, holding the ceiling above her. She scanned the castle, searching for anyone that might be waiting. The path before her came to end and in front of her was a diamond shaped mural. It towered over her, showing the image of a woman, she wasn't in white though. Her outfit seemed to be more pink, with gold shoulder pads and a gold crown on her head. She held a sword in front of her, it looked to be the very same sword that Adora now held in her hand. There was writing below the mural, one word etched amongst the bareness of the castle: 'She-Ra'.

She had seen that word before. She had asked Angella about it when she first discovered it in an old book in First Ones' writings. The Queen had explained that once Etheria had a hero, one called 'She-Ra', but she had disappeared years before the Horde had arrived. Angella seemed hesitant to talk about her and thus Adora never pressed her for more information. She uttered the word aloud, maybe it was another password. The writing immediately lit up and so did the room. The mural glowed as well and suddenly a woman appeared before her. It was the sapphire woman.

"Adora," she said, her voice still monotone. Apparently that wasn't going to change, much to Adora's disappointment.

"Um, yes..?" Adora awkwardly answered, staring up at the sapphire woman towering over her. She looked almost see through, like she wasn't actually a person but rather a- "A-are you a hologram?" she couldn't stop herself from asking. She wanted to mentally slap herself. She suddenly realized that it might have been rude to voice that out loud. She had to fix her error, maybe the woman wouldn't be too mad- "N-not that's there's anything wrong with holograms!" Stop talking! Stop talking! "O-or that you look like a hologram! I'm um… I'm Adora," she thrusted her free hand out to shake hands with the stranger. The woman stared at her outreached hand but made no move to shake it. Adora drew her hand back awkwardly and rubbed the back of her head

nervously with it, “S-sorry.”
The woman watched her for a moment. There was no emotion on her face and it was unnerving. Adora wondered if she could just leave, maybe this woman was a hologram, maybe she wouldn’t notice if they just left-

“I have been watching you,” the woman finally said. There was no emotion behind her words, nothing to indicate how she should take those words.

“Oh! Uh… O…Okay,” Adora mumbled, unsure how to continue the conversation. What did that mean? How had the woman been watching her? She had never seen this woman before, well, aside from her dreams recently.

“So um… Where… Wh-where am I? Exactly?”

“You are in the crystal castle,” came the simple answer. Crystal Castle… That still didn’t answer anything… Not really at least.

“And what exactly is the crystal castle?” Adora asked, hoping for a clearer answer this time.

“Follow me,” the woman answered. So maybe she wouldn’t get a clear answer. The woman turned around and began to journey further into the castle, not waiting for Adora to follow.

“W-wait!” Adora called out and sprinted after her. She was fast, faster than Adora assumed she would be. She couldn’t hold back her questions anymore. The woman continued on but they could at least talk as they strolled through the hallway, right?

“Where am I? Why did you call me? How did you know my name? Why were you appearing in my dreams?” She ran through all her questions in a hurry, not even stopping for an answer. She was afraid that the woman wouldn’t give an explanation, so she filled the silence she expected with more questions. To her surprise though, the woman did respond when she was done.

“You are in the crystal castle. I called you because it is time. I have watched you since you were born. I appeared in your dreams because it was the only way I could reach you,” the woman answered, there was still no emotion in her words.

Finally they came to a stop in a large room. It looked much like the first room she had come across in the castle. The only difference was there was no mural and no door. Ahead of them, it looked as though the room would split off into several different hallways. “Why am I here?” Adora asked.

“Because Etheria needs a hero.”

Okay… Etheria needs a hero. Etheria had been at war for years now. It’s needed a hero for years, that was obvious. Why did that mean that she needed to be at the crystal castle though… Unless… “Etheria needs She-Ra,” the woman added.

“I’m not… I’m not She-Ra. I’m just Adora, I’m…” What was she exactly? She was the adopted princess of Bright Moon, she wasn’t ever going to be queen but she was okay with that. She was Glimmer’s sister. She was Bow’s friend. She was General Juliet’s promising student. “I’m not She-Ra. I’m sorry! B-but I could help you look for her, if you think she’s still alive!” Angella was immortal, maybe She-Ra was too, “I’ve heard about her! I’m sure I could find her if-”

“No,” the lady cut her off. Adora became silent and waited for the woman to continue, “You misunderstand. You have the sword,” she pointed at the sword still in Adora’s right hand, “You are She-Ra.”

“Woah! Woah!” Adora backed away as she stammered, “I’m- I’m n-not She-Ra… Like I said I’m… I’m just-”

“You can wield the sword,” the woman began to talk over her.

“N-no! I’m just… I mean I… I w-want to be a hero… Maybe… Maybe someday but I’m not She-Ra!”

“You are,” came the woman’s simple reply. Adora finally stopped. She glanced at the sword in her. It had stopped glowing some time ago.

“When you say these words: ‘for the honor of Grayskull’, you will become She-Ra.”

Adora looked at her confused. She thought about the words the woman just said. “F-for the honor of G-Grayskull?” She repeated and the sword lit up in a blinding light. The light faded and she now stood taller, two or three feet taller in fact. Her red jacket was gone, she was now dressed in all white. She dropped the sword and immediately glowed again and returned to her previous height and outfit.

“Wh-what was that?!?! Wh-what happened to me?!?!”
“You are the next She-Ra,” the woman answered.

“What do you mean ‘next’? H-how did I do that?! What is going on?!” Adora wanted to scream, she almost was. The sword still laid by her feet, forgotten by her for now. The woman pointed at the sword on the ground and Adora followed her gesture until her eyes landed upon it. She snatched it off of the ground and stared at the woman waiting for an answer.

“Adora, you must take on the mantle of She-Ra. You must restore balance.” Then just as quickly as she had appeared, the woman vanished. Adora stood alone, her breaths suddenly coming out quick and uneven. The woman’s voice rang out in the castle, “You are not ready yet. Return when you are ready.” A line on the floor lit up, indicating which way Adora should go in the castle. She followed it and was soon out of the castle.

It was day time now. It almost looked to be about noon. She had stayed out way longer than she had intended to. Everyone at the castle was most likely up and they had probably noticed her absence. She glanced at the sword in her hand. She wasn’t sure how she would explain everything to them. She would have to though. Return when you're ready. She wasn’t sure what she

needed to get ready for. Maybe Angella or General Juliet could help her figure it out. She needed to return home. She looked back at the crystal castle once more and then began the long trek back to Bright Moon.

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